Table 3.12 Shielding effect from inner shell electrons (Slater's rules)

Electron Group	Electron of interest either S or P	Electron of interest either d or f
n	0.35 (0.30 for (S electron)	0.35
(n-1)	0.85	1.00
(n-2) and others	1.00	1.00

Table 3.13 Atomic radius (covalent radius) of second period elements.

Elements	Effective nuclear charge	Covalent radius (pm)
$_3$Li	1.30	152
$_4$Be	1.95	111
$_5$B	2.60	89
$_6$C	3.25	77
$_7$N	3.90	74
$_8$O	4.55	66
$_9$F	5.20	64
$_{10}$Ne	5.85	

* Van der waals radius

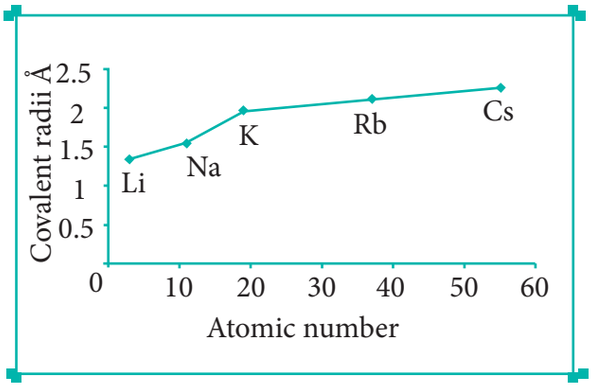
Evaluate Yourself

4. Using Slater's rule calculate the effective nuclear charge on a 3p electron in aluminium and chlorine. Explain how these results relate to the atomic radii of the two atoms.

Variation in Group

In the periodic table, the atomic radius of elements increases down the group. As we move down a group, new shells are opened to accommodate the newly added valence electrons. As a result, the distance between the centre of the nucleus and the outermost shell containing the valence electron increases. Hence, the atomic radius increases. The trend in the variation of the atomic radius of the alkali metals down the group os shown below.

Table 3.14 Variation of covalent radius of group 1 elements



Element	Outermost shell containing valence electron	Covalent radius (Å)
Li	L (n=2)	1.34
Na	M (n=3)	1.54
K	N (n=4)	1.96
Rb	O (n=5)	2.11
Cs	P (n=6)	2.25

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